


THE DIY AUDIT PLAYBOOK

The OBG360 Amazon Audit

How to run a full audit on your own account —
the exact seven-part system, step by step.

The system behind 500+ audits, laid out so you can run it yourself. No fluff.

INSIDE THIS PLAYBOOK



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START HERE

The exact system behind 500+ audits

Most brands never really audit their Amazon account. They toggle tactics — new images one week, a bid tweak the next — and hope. A real audit swaps the guessing for a diagnosis: what's actually holding growth back, and what to fix first.

We've run over 500 Amazon account audits in the last 12 months. This is the real step-by-step system our team uses on every one — the same seven-part diagnostic, adapted so you can run it on your own account. Work through it in order; each step tells you the exact report to open, what to record, and what it means. Budget about 6–7 hours for a proper pass.

The results speak for themselves. This is the same diagnostic behind our client work: a brand taken from \$100K to \$3M in 18 months (a 30× lift, and an exit), another from \$0 to \$500K in a year, and one client's contribution profit grown from \$230K to \$780K. Every turnaround starts here — with an honest look at the numbers.

A note on reading the numbers: the same figure can mean opposite things for different brands. Where interpretation depends on the kind of business you run, you'll see a short "how to read this for your business" note.

ACTION**What you'll walk away with**

A real diagnosis of your account — market, visibility, conversion, ads, logistics, profit, and risk, in one pass.

Your single biggest constraint — the one thing holding growth back.

A sequenced 90-day plan — what to fix first, second, third.

STEP 01 · ABOUT 20 MIN

Set up: tools, data window & ASINs

1) The tools you'll use

Tool	What it is	What you'll pull from it
Amazon Seller Central	Your account backend	Business Reports · Inventory · Account Health · Fee Preview · Returns
Brand Analytics	Inside Seller Central (needs Brand Registry)	Search Query Performance — your share of category demand
A keyword tool	DataDive or Helium 10	Niche size, competitor positioning, reverse-ASIN keyword gaps
ChatGPT (or any AI)	Analysis assistant	Scoring your images; summarizing your reviews & returns

2) Set your data window

Use the last 30 days for a current snapshot and the last 90 days for trends. Note the exact dates and keep them consistent across every step.

3) Pick 3 focus ASINs

WHERE Seller Central > Reports > Business Reports > Detail Page Sales & Traffic by Child Item

You don't audit every SKU in depth — pick three representative ones and go deep. Sort by sales and choose a top performer, a middle performer, and a weak-but-strategically-important one. Note each ASIN, its short title, and its role; you'll reference these three throughout.

STEP 02 · ABOUT 40 MIN

Market & Customer Intelligence

First, understand the water you're swimming in: how big the category is, who's winning, and what share of demand you actually hold.

2.1 Category & competitor snapshot

WHERE Keyword tool (DataDive / Helium 10) — niche research + 3–5 competitor ASINs per focus product

1. Record market size (search volume) as High / Medium / Low and the 12-month demand trend as Growing / Flat / Declining.
2. For each focus ASIN, note your price, review count, and rating versus the competitor range and average — where you're strong and where you're outgunned.

2.2 Your share of demand (SQP)

WHERE Seller Central > Brand Analytics > Search Query Performance (Brand level, last 30 days or the quarter)

1. Record your Impression, Click, and Purchase share on your top queries. Flag any high-volume query where demand is strong but your presence is near-zero — that's missed demand.

WHAT IT MEANS

This tells you whether your ceiling is high (a big, growing, beatable category) or whether you're fighting for scraps — and it frames every recommendation later.

HOW TO READ THIS FOR YOUR BUSINESS

Newer / small brand — near-zero share on the big terms is expected. Look for one smaller, winnable pocket of demand.

Established brand — if you hold share on the head terms, the opportunity is usually defending and expanding it, not chasing new niches.

STEP 03 · ABOUT 50 MIN

Listing Visibility (SEO & discoverability)

Now find out where you show up in search — and where you don't but should.

3.1 Reverse-ASIN keyword gap

WHERE Keyword tool > Reverse ASIN / Keyword Intersection — your ASIN + 3–5 competitor ASINs
Sort the relevant, high-volume keywords into four buckets (≈10–15 each):

Missing high-intent	Competitors rank, you're not even indexed — your biggest gaps.
Rank 20–50	Indexed, mid-page — realistic to push up.
Rank 50–100	Weak but relevant — longer-term.
Irrelevant	You rank but shouldn't care — ignore.

3.2 Can you actually win it? (the review wall)

Before chasing a keyword, look at page 1: the median review count of the products ranking there is your "review wall." You can out-work a few hundred reviews; you can't out-work tens of thousands.

The niche	Page-1 median reviews	Verdict
A niche you can win	~200	Contestable — chase it organically
A defensible niche	~900	Winnable with effort / defend if you're there
A walled niche	9,000+	Compete with ads or a sub-angle, not organic

3.3 Turn the gaps into a keyword plan

Prioritize relevance over raw volume. A keyword at 75% relevance and 3,000 searches beats one at 40% relevance and 10,000 — it actually converts, so it actually ranks. Drop branded, duplicate, and off-topic terms, then give every keyword a home:

Title	Your few highest-relevance, highest-volume keywords — placed early.
Bullets	Mid-priority keywords woven into benefit copy (never stuffed).
Description / A+	Secondary and long-tail terms in natural sentences.
Backend search terms	Everything left — synonyms, misspellings, alternates. 250 bytes, no brand names, no repeats.

HOW TO READ THIS FOR YOUR BUSINESS

Not yet ranking — this step is central. Pick the one low-wall keyword cluster you can realistically win and concentrate there.

Category leader — you're likely already the wall. The job is defending position, not climbing.

STEP 04 · ABOUT 60 MIN

Conversion Rate Analysis

Conversion is the highest-leverage number on Amazon. It compounds into everything else: a listing that converts better ranks higher, makes your ads cheaper, and turns the same traffic into more sales. Lifting conversion from 13% to 15% is a 15% sales increase — with zero extra ad spend. For your focus ASINs, find out whether your traffic is converting, and if not, why.

Two levers move it. Click-through (CTR) — driven mostly by your main image, price, title, and any deal badge — and **conversion (CVR)** — driven by your full image stack, price, reviews, and A+ content. Start by seeing where each product sits:

Starved — converts, low traffic Great funnel, few visitors → your problem is exposure. Spend more on acquisition; build reviews.	Strong — converts + traffic You're winning. Protect the position and scale.
Foundational — weak at both Rank and convert from scratch before pouring in traffic.	Leaky — traffic, low conversion Traffic wasted → fix price, reviews, images, or you're paying to lose.

4.1 Diagnose the listing

WHERE Your live product pages + ChatGPT + Seller Central > Business Reports (unit-session %)

1. Score your images with AI — upload your main + 5 gallery images to ChatGPT: "Score each 1–10 for clarity, benefit communication, and mobile legibility; name the weakest and why."
2. Mine your reviews — paste recent reviews (and a top competitor's) into ChatGPT for the top 3–5 recurring complaints, praises, and the words customers actually use. That language belongs in your listing.
3. Benchmark each focus ASIN's conversion vs your other products and the category; flag anything ~20%+ below where it should be.

4.2 Grade your listing against the standard

This is the bar OBG builds every listing to (our Growth PDP System™). Check yours against it — each miss is conversion left on the table:

Main image	White background, no text or props, product fills the frame. Your single biggest CTR driver.
Image stack	5–6 secondary images: lifestyle, feature breakdown, benefits, comparison / guarantee, social proof. Must be mobile-legible.
Title	[Root keyword] – [top feature or use] [key benefit] [format / count]. Under 200 characters, best keywords first.
Bullets	5 bullets, each under ~250 characters, each a distinct benefit in natural language (no stuffing).
Description / A+	Premium A+ with before/after or a comparison chart; a 1,000–2,000-character story in your customers' words.
Backend	250 bytes of synonyms, misspellings, and long-tails — no brand names, no

repeats.

4.3 Then test your way up — don't guess

The winning listing is found, not written. Run split tests (Amazon's "Manage Your Experiments," or a testing tool) one element at a time, in order of impact: main image → image stack → title → bullets → price. Change only one thing per test, keep the winner, and weight the decision toward CVR — not raw clicks.

WHAT IT MEANS

Lots of traffic but low conversion means fix the listing (this step). Great conversion but little traffic means the problem is exposure — Steps 02–03 and advertising.

HOW TO READ THIS FOR YOUR BUSINESS

Big "hero" product — a lowish conversion rate can be normal; check whether a refill or related product is where the money actually is.

Subscription / replenishment — a modest first-order conversion is fine if buyers come back; judge it with repeat rate, not in isolation.

STEP 05 · ABOUT 90 MIN

Advertising Structure & Performance

The longest step. Pull your ad reports and judge where money is working and where it's leaking.

WHERE Amazon Ads › Sponsored ads reports — export Campaign, Search Term & Placement reports (last 30 days)

5.1 Structure & per-ASIN performance

1. Scan the campaigns: branded vs non-branded separated? auto + manual coverage? sensible match types? Write a few lines on how organized (or sprawling) it is.
2. For each focus ASIN, total ad spend, ad sales, ACOS and ROAS.
3. **Compute Real TACOS** = ad spend ÷ that product's total (ad + organic) sales. The honest number: if it's a big share of total revenue — or above it — the product is ad-dependent or losing money.

5.2 Find the leaks

1. **From the Search Term report, find wasted spend** — clicks with zero sales and terms far above your target ACOS. Total it as a % of spend; that's your quickest saving.
2. From the Placement report, compare Top-of-Search vs Product-Page ROAS and shift budget toward what converts.
3. Check branded vs non-branded: overpaying for your own name, or is non-branded underfunded?

WHAT IT MEANS

Your ad move is not automatically "cut." It depends on Steps 03–04:

If you're...	...the move is
Unprofitable / ads > revenue	CUT the losing spend; set breakeven ACOS ceilings
Already efficient (low TACOS)	HOLD & scale — judge on lifetime value, not first-order ACOS
Restricted / can't ship widely	FIX buyability before you spend more
Great funnel, low traffic	SPEND MORE — you're under-investing in a machine that converts

5.3 Which phase is each product in?

The right ACOS and TACOS aren't fixed — they depend on where a product is in its lifecycle.

This is the framework we run on: place each of your products in a phase and set the targets accordingly.

Phase	What you're doing	ACOS / TACOS target
Launch	New listing — buy early sales and rank on your most relevant keywords; use Vine for reviews.	Up to ~2× breakeven ACOS · TACOS n/a
Trimming	Cut the losers; lower bids on anything ~20% over breakeven; add negatives.	Breakeven ACOS or better · TACOS 8–12%
Growth	Expand to new keywords + Sponsored Brands / Display once the listing is dialed in.	Breakeven on core; up to +50% on research · TACOS 8–14%
Maturity	Defend and sustain; pause anything that still can't hit breakeven.	Breakeven or better · TACOS 8–12%

STEP 06 · ABOUT 30 MIN

Logistics & Operations

Inventory quietly makes or breaks the account — especially for repeat-purchase brands.

WHERE Seller Central > Reports > Inventory (FBA Inventory Age / Manage Inventory) + Business Reports

1. **Inventory age:** for each focus ASIN, look at how stock is distributed by age. Old, slow-moving stock is trapped cash and long-term storage fees.
2. **Stock-outs:** find any period a focus ASIN went out of stock in the last 90 days and note the hit to sessions, sales, and rank. A stock-out on a ranking product can undo months of momentum.
3. **Health score:** rate the account Green / Yellow / Red on inventory stability, sell-through, age risk, restock reliability, and readiness to scale ads.

HOW TO READ THIS FOR YOUR BUSINESS

Consumable / subscription — never stocking out is existential (a stock-out breaks subscriptions). Make sure Subscribe & Save is on and buffers are healthy.

One-time / durable — focus on overstock and storage fees rather than replenishment.

STEP 07 · ABOUT 45 MIN

SKU-Level Profitability

This is the step you can't fake — and the one that matters most. Every product has to earn its place. You need real, SKU-by-SKU profit, not a guess: revenue and even ACOS can look fine while a product loses money on every single order once you count product cost, all Amazon fees, storage, returns, and ads.

WHERE A profit-analytics tool — Sellerboard or Sellerise — connected to your account, with your true product costs loaded

Use a real tool, not a spreadsheet. Amazon's fees (referral, FBA, storage, low-inventory surcharge, returns processing) vary by product and change over time. Sellerboard or Sellerise pull the actual fees per order from Amazon and subtract your loaded COGS, giving you true contribution profit for every SKU. That's the only number that tells the truth — a 30% margin assumption will hide the products that are quietly bleeding you.

Do this for every SKU — not just your focus three

- 1. Load your true landed COGS** for each SKU into the tool (product + inbound freight + prep). Everything below depends on this input — get it right.
- 2. Read each SKU's contribution profit and margin** over the last 30 and 90 days. Contribution profit = Total Sales – (Landed Product Cost + Total Advertising Cost + Total Amazon Fees + Refunds).
- 3. Mark every SKU profitable / breakeven / losing.** The standard is simple and non-negotiable: every single product should be profitable, or on a clear, dated path to it.

ACTION

The standard — every SKU pulls its weight

Profitable — keep it; if it can also rank or scale, invest behind it.

Breakeven — fix the leak (price, COGS, fees, ACOS, or returns) before you spend a dollar scaling it.

Losing money — raise price, cut cost or ACOS, fix the fee/return driver, or discontinue. Never let a loser bleed under the winners.

Then hunt the hidden killers the P&L reveals: products with healthy sales but thin or negative margin (fees or returns eating them alive), oversized or heavy items crushed by FBA size-tier and storage fees, and SKUs where ad cost quietly turns a profitable product into a loss.

HOW TO READ THIS FOR YOUR BUSINESS

Many variations / sizes — check every child SKU. A "profitable" parent routinely hides money-losing variations.

Heavy / bulky products — FBA size tiers, dimensional weight, and storage fees can flip the math; watch these closely.

Low-priced items (< ~\$15) — fixed fees eat a huge share; many simply can't be profitable on FBA without a price or pack-size change.

STEP 08 · ABOUT 30 MIN

Fees, reimbursements & FBA cost recovery

This is the “found money” step. Amazon makes tens of thousands of fee and inventory adjustments against your account, and a share of them are wrong — in Amazon’s favor. There are two pools to go after: money Amazon owes you back, and fees you’re overpaying every single day.

8.1 Reimbursements — money Amazon owes you

WHERE Seller Central > Reports > Payments & Fulfillment (Inventory Adjustments, Reimbursements) — or a reconciliation tool / Sellerise

1. **Reconcile lost & damaged inventory** — units Amazon lost or damaged in its warehouses and never reimbursed. There’s a filing window (often ~60 days for many case types), so this is use-it-or-lose-it money.
2. **Check customer-return discrepancies** — refunds issued to a customer where the unit never came back to you, or returned damaged and wasn’t credited.
3. **Review removals, disposals & inbound shortages** — items lost in transit to the warehouse or during removals.

WATCH OUT

File it — don’t just find it

Amazon won’t pay you back automatically; you (or a tool) have to open the cases with proof, inside the window. Most brands are owed hundreds or thousands they never claim. If the volume is real, a reimbursement service or Sellerise’s recovery tools pay for themselves many times over.

8.2 FBA fees — money you’re overpaying

WHERE Seller Central > Manage Inventory (Fee Preview / FBA fees) + Inventory > FBA Inventory Age & storage reports

1. **Request a re-measurement** on any product where Amazon’s recorded size or weight looks too high. The size tier drives the fulfillment fee — a wrong measurement overcharges you on every unit you sell.
2. **Cut storage & aged-inventory surcharges** — draw down anything sitting past ~180–365 days; long-term-storage and aged-inventory fees stack up fast.
3. **Balance the low-inventory fee against overstock** — aim for roughly 60–120 days of cover: enough that Amazon doesn’t hit you with the low-inventory fee, not so much that storage eats your margin.

HOW TO READ THIS FOR YOUR BUSINESS

Heavy / bulky products — a single wrong size-tier classification overcharges you the most; re-measurement is worth real money here.

Fast movers — the low-inventory fee is the bigger risk; keep buffers healthy so you never drop under ~30 days.

STEP 09 · ABOUT 45 MIN

Account Health, Compliance & Brand Protection

The account that generates all this revenue can be taken down overnight. This isn't a one-time check — it's ongoing monitoring. Set it up on a cadence: a few things daily, a few weekly, one monthly. Here's the exact routine our team runs for clients.

Daily — catch problems before they cost you

WHERE Seller Central > Performance Notifications · Manage Inventory · Business Reports (Featured Offer %)

1. **Performance notifications & policy violations** — read every new one; respond or appeal immediately where Amazon allows. These are how suspensions start.
2. **Sweep the whole Manage Inventory screen** — not just suppressed/stranded listings. Amazon also flags pricing alerts, backend-field recommendations, and listing-quality issues. Fix anything that hurts visibility or conversion.
3. **Buy Box, hijackers & unauthorized sellers** — check who's on your listings and your Featured Offer (Buy Box) %. New third-party sellers on your ASINs, or a dropping Buy Box, mean hijackers, counterfeit, or MAP breakers stealing your sales — act fast (this is OBG's 360 Brand Protection™).
4. **Scan your top-revenue SKUs by eye** — sort by sales and look at your hero products directly; the issues that matter most often don't trip an automated filter.

Weekly — protect the catalog

1. **Account Health dashboard** — read the AHR and every Policy Compliance category. Read the Priority Actions, not just the score: an account can show a perfect number and still be flagged "At Risk" from one regulatory or certification item.
2. **Review Listing Updates (AI changes)** — Amazon's AI silently rewrites your titles, bullets, images, and attributes. You have 14 days to Agree / Disagree / Fix before it auto-publishes. Most sellers never look — check weekly and revert anything that hurts your SEO or accuracy.
3. **Voice of the Customer + negative feedback** — find Poor / Very Poor ASINs and recurring complaints; request removal of any feedback that violates policy.

Monthly — your insurance policy

1. **Back up your Catalog Listing Report (CLR)**. Download it from Inventory > Inventory Reports and save it. If Amazon's AI or a bad upload corrupts your listings, this backup is how you restore titles, bullets, and variations fast.

WATCH OUT

The one that can take you down

In a regulated or restricted category (supplements, self-defense, electronics, anything age- or hazmat-gated), a certification or restricted-product flag can suspend the whole account. If that's you, this section is your #1 priority — clear it before anything else.

STEP 10 · ABOUT 20 MIN

Untapped growth levers

Once the foundation is solid, these are the levers most brands leave on the table. Run down the list and flag two or three you're not using — they're usually quick wins.

Deals & Prime events	Prime Day, Black Friday/Cyber Monday, and Best Deal / Lightning Deals — plan inventory and spend around the days that move the most volume.
Coupons & promotions	Clippable coupons and promos add a badge in search and lift conversion — test on hero SKUs.
Brand Tailored Promotions	Target specific shopper segments — brand followers, repeat customers, cart abandoners, at-risk customers — with tailored discounts. High-intent audiences at low cost.
Creator Connections	Amazon's influencer/affiliate program — pay creators on performance to drive external traffic that Amazon rewards.
Subscribe & Save	On any consumable — turns one-time buyers into recurring, predictable revenue.
B2B / Amazon Business	Business pricing and quantity discounts open a whole buyer segment most sellers ignore.
Pricing tests	Small price moves within your margin can lift conversion and profit more than any new campaign.

STEP 11 · ABOUT 45 MIN

Turn it into a plan

You've diagnosed market, visibility, conversion, advertising, logistics, profitability, and account health. Pull it together into an action plan — organized by product, not a pile of tasks.

For each of your three focus ASINs, write:

1. **High / Medium / Low impact recommendations** — strategic, not "tweak this word." (e.g. High: "rebuild PPC around the missing high-intent keywords from Step 03.")
2. **Risks if ignored** — 2–3 lines ("stays unprofitable at current TACOS," "suppressed variation keeps dragging rank").

Then name the three roles:

1. **Best scaling candidate** — healthy, profitable, ready for more fuel.
2. **Efficiency-only** — keep it lean; don't scale until it's fixed.
3. **Fix-or-deprioritize** — parked until a specific problem is solved.

Sequence it: stabilize the economics first, fix your single biggest constraint next, then compound what works. Your focus is wherever your biggest gap is — and now you can name it.

PRINT THIS

The one-page audit checklist

Work top to bottom — each row is the one thing to walk away with from that step. Pin it above your desk and re-run it monthly (weekly if you're under pressure).

Step	The one thing to walk away with
01 • Setup	Your 3 focus ASINs (top / middle / weak) and your 30- & 90-day windows
02 • Market	Category size + your share of demand; where the real opportunity is
03 • Visibility	Your missing high-intent keywords — and whether any niche is winnable
04 • Conversion	Which listings leak traffic, and why (images / reviews / price)
05 • Advertising	Real TACOS per product + the total wasted spend to cut
06 • Logistics	Any stock-out risk on winners; overstock draining cash
07 • Profitability	Every SKU's true contribution profit (Sellerboard / Sellerise) — each one profitable, breakeven, or losing
08 • Fees & money back	Reimbursements Amazon owes you filed; FBA size / storage / low-inventory fees trimmed
09 • Account health	Monitoring live (daily/weekly/monthly): Priority Actions, hijackers, AI listing changes, CLR backup
10 • Untapped levers	2–3 unused growth levers picked (deals, coupons, Posts, S&S, B2B, pricing)
11 • Plan	Your #1 constraint + each ASIN tagged scale / efficiency / fix

PREFER WE JUST DO IT FOR YOU?

We'll run the whole OBG360 Audit — and hand you the plan.

That's a real day of work — and it's exactly what we do, 500+ times over. The OBG360 Amazon Audit is the done-for-you version of this playbook: run by the founders, delivered as a clear, sequenced plan tailored to your brand, with the numbers pulled and interpreted for you.

Why OBG: founder-led, 100% in-house, paid on your contribution profit — not your ad spend. We hate agencies. That's why we built this one.

Book your OBG360 Audit →

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REAL RESULTS FROM REAL BRANDS

"OBG literally 30X'd our Amazon sales in less than 18 months, from \$100K to \$3M per year — which enabled us to scale into retail and ultimately exit." — **Doug Gonterman, NumNum Baby**

"Our sales and profit are up over 50% year over year. They take on all the headaches of Amazon — a game changer." — **Lori Cortright, CFO, Streetwise Security**

"We've worked with many agencies — OBG's expertise and dedication are unmatched." — **Lynn Cartwright, Minerva Research Labs NA**